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'BROADVIEW SIX' CASE

Trial looms for trustee, others

PROSECUTORS MUST EXPLAIN REDACTIONS:

A federal judge has taken the highly unusual step to order prosecutors and their supervisors into court Thursday to explain redactions made to portions of grand jury transcripts in the "Broadview Six" case against Operation Midway Blitz protesters. The move comes two days after the federal judge agreed to review unredacted portions of the grand jury transcripts that led to the original felony conspiracy indictment in the case.

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Charges stemming from ICE protest have been nightmare for progressive Oak Park politician

By Tess Kenny
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

For months, Brian Straw has watched his 6-year-old daughter and 11-year-old son struggle with nightmares. As a parent, Straw was prepared for middle-of-the-night wakeups, for when his kids would come to him worried about monsters under the bed.

He didn't expect these kinds of nightmares. Ones about whether their dad will come home from court. For those are steeped in reality.

Straw, a local elected official in

west suburban Oak Park, is among the four remaining "Broadview Six" defendants. After half a year of litigation in the case, which was initially indicted as a federal conspiracy, Straw is bringing his story to the fore.

"The last six and a half, seven months of my life," the Oak Park trustee says, "have been hell."

A jury trial in the case looms next week. The politically charged prosecution is down to misdemeanor counts of impeding an immigration agent after a federal

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Brian Straw, an Oak Park trustee and one of the four remaining defendants in the "Broadview Six" case, sits across from the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse on May 11. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

CHICAGO CITY COUNCIL



Ald. Jessie Fuentes, 26th, listens in as Ald. Walter "Red" Burnett, 27th, speaks about raises for tipped workers during the City Council meeting at Chicago City Hall on Wednesday. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

GENERAL ASSEMBLY

Board to cap drug prices on table

Bill is part of push by Dems to address affordability crisis

By Jeremy Gorner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SPRINGFIELD — With 11 days remaining in their spring legislative session, Illinois lawmakers are considering legislation that would create a state panel empowered to review the costs of prescription drug prices and whether medicine is inaccessible to those who need it the most.

The bill to establish a Prescription Drug Affordability Board is part of a broader push by Democrats to address an affordability crisis that has rocked Illinois and the rest of the country. But opponents argue the panel would do little to actually lower prices while creating new layers of bureaucracy in state government. The bill passed 8-4 along party lines Wednesday in the House Executive Committee and now awaits a vote by the full House.

Supporters see the board as a vehicle to rein in runaway drug costs, a politically charged issue that the federal government has also begun to address through Biden-era provisions taking effect this year.

Democratic state Rep. Nabeela Syed of Palatine, a main sponsor of the bill, called

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Tipped wage raises frozen

Aldermen vote to stop increases for at least 2 years, dealing big blow to Johnson's agenda

By Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Aldermen voted to freeze Chicago's "One Fair Wage" ordinance Wednesday, halting required raises for tipped workers like waiters who now get paid below the city minimum.

The City Council's move stops

the increases for at least two years. The veto-proof majority — just one alderman voted against the change — hardly marks an end to the fight, instead foreshadowing likely future pushes by the restaurant lobby to fully end the raises. Wednesday's outcome is also a major blow to a key win for Mayor Brandon Johnson and his work-

ing-class agenda.

Johnson, his options diminished by the decisive vote, tried to cast it as a thoughtful compromise later Wednesday. He said he would not veto the measure and added that he was not "completely satisfied" with the change, but was "encouraged by the openness in good faith to create dialogue and compromise."

"We're not going to sit here and act like what just happened isn't problematic," he said. "Of course my preference would always be

to ensure that raises happen ... but in the end, this is the compromise that folks agreed upon."

Aldermen voted in March to indefinitely stop One Fair Wage, but Johnson vetoed that move, arguing then that the subminimum wage "has its vestiges tied to slavery."

Wednesday's compromise package, which delays the annual pay bumps for tipped workers for two

US indicts ex-Cuba leader Raúl Castro

By Joshua Goodman
and Alanna Durkin Richer
ASSOCIATED PRESS

MIAMI — Federal prosecutors Wednesday announced charges against former Cuban President Raúl Castro in the 1996 downing of civilian planes operated by Miami-based exiles as the Trump administration escalated pressure on the socialist government.

The indictment was related to Castro's alleged role in the shoot-down of two small planes operated by the exile group Brothers

to the Rescue. Castro, now 94, was Cuba's defense minister at the time. The charges included murder and destruction of an airplane.

Acting Attorney General Todd Blanche and other top Justice Department officials made the announcement in Miami at a ceremony to honor those killed in the shootdown.

"For nearly 30 years, the families of four murdered Americans have waited for justice," Blanche said. "They were unarmed civilians and were flying humani-

tarian missions for the rescue and protection of people fleeing oppression across the Florida straits."

Asked to what lengths American authorities would go to bring Castro to face charges in the U.S., Blanche said: "There was a warrant issued for his arrest. So we expect that he will show up here, by his own will or by another way."

The federal government, he said, indicts people outside the United States "all the time" and

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WILLIAM PULLINSI 1939-2026



ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE 2015

'A gentle giant of Chicago theater'

William Pullinsi, the founding artistic director of the Candlelight Dinner Playhouse in southwest suburban Summit and widely regarded as the founder of dinner theater in America, died on Sunday at home in Dyer, Indiana. He was 86. **Page A9**

Pritzker, NFL talk stadium

In discussions with NFL Commissioner Roger Goodell, governor reiterated that Bears are not considering Chicago. **Chicagoland, Page A3**

CPD extremist ties banned

Aldermen passed a measure banning cops with ties to extremist groups from working in the police department. **Chicagoland, Page A5**

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